

ISSUE 01 Q2²⁰₂₆

94.4

THE FIELDS CONVICTION INDEX,
SOUTHERN GOLD COAST

In Q2 2026, the Fields Conviction Index for the southern Gold Coast closed at 94.4 — below the five-year baseline of 100, and down from 100.1 in Q1. Median house prices held or rose across Robina, Burleigh Waters and Varsity Lakes, yet the number of homes sold ran roughly half its year-earlier level. The headline price line and the underlying conviction line are now telling different stories: a market cooling by volume, not by value.



THE QUARTER

A loud sale in a quiet market

On a Friday afternoon in April, on a lakefront street in Robina, bidding closed on a home with twenty-two metres of water frontage. The hammer fell at \$2,410,000 — more than double what it last changed hands for in 2020. It was one of the loudest moments of the quarter. Most of the quarter was quiet.

Judged by the trailing-twelve-month median — the measure that doesn't lurch on a handful of sales — prices in all three suburbs held or rose. Judged by how many homes actually sold, the quarter was among the thinnest in years: turnover ran roughly half its year-earlier level, listings built up, and homes took longer to find a buyer. With the cash rate at 4.35% after three rises, and a tax change announced mid-quarter, the pressure landed on **activity, not price**.

When this report last read the market, at the close of Q1, the Conviction Index sat at 100.1 — right on the line between balanced and cooling. A quarter later it reads 94.4. Nothing here suggests prices falling; it suggests a market catching its breath.

WHAT FIRMED

- Trailing-12-month median still rising in all three suburbs
- Wages (+3.4%) and household spending — the best leading indicators — both climbing
- Burleigh Waters' average time-to-sell fell sharply (60.8 → 42.5 days)

WHAT SOFTENED

- Single-quarter sales down 44–56% on a year earlier
- Listings building; days-on-market lengthening in Robina and Varsity Lakes
- The Conviction Index below its 100 baseline

WHAT TO WATCH

- The 1 July 2027 negative-gearing & CGT changes (p.5)
- The 11 August RBA decision; Q2 CPI lands 29 July
- Whether sellers meet the market, or buyers return first

— *read the market with us this quarter,*

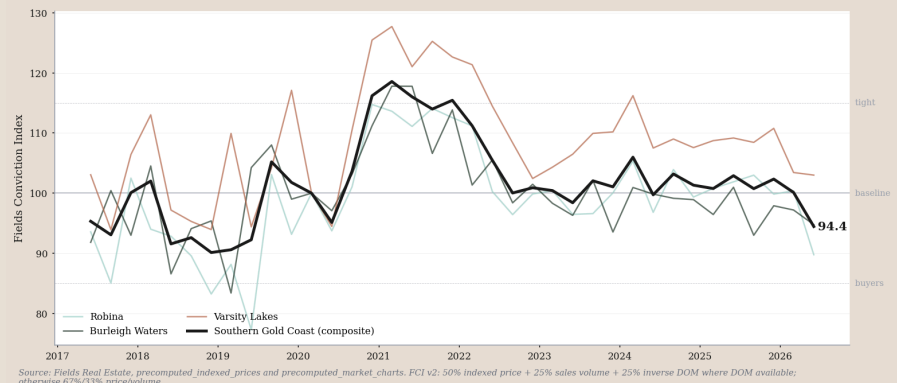
Will Simpson · Founder, Fields Estate

94.4
CONVICTION INDEX ·
COMPOSITE

Price, sales volume and days-on-market, measured against each suburb's own five-year history. 100 = balanced. Down from 100.1 in Q1.

The Fields Conviction Index since Q1 2017

Q1 2020 baseline = 100. Composite is transaction-weighted across the three core suburbs.



The Fields Conviction Index by suburb + composite, 2017 – Q2 2026. Q1 2020 = 100.

ROBINA

89.8

▼ from 100.4

BURLEIGH WATERS

94.8

▼ from 97.2

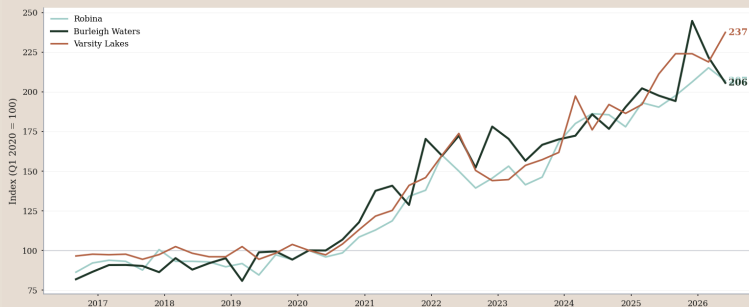
VARSITY LAKES

103.0

● held above 100

Indexed median price by suburb, Q1 2020 = 100

Robina, Burleigh Waters and Varsity Lakes have risen 2.1–2.4× since the start of 2020.



Indexed median house price, Q1 2020 = 100. All three have risen 2.1–2.4× since 2020.

SUBURB	MEDIAN	YOY	QOQ
Robina	\$1,500,000	+8.7%	-3.8%
Burleigh W.	\$1,790,000	+4.1%	-7.3%
Varsity L.	\$1,484,000	+12.4%	+8.5%*

*12 sales — read the trailing trend, not the quarter.
Single quarters fall on thin samples against a rolling line still climbing.

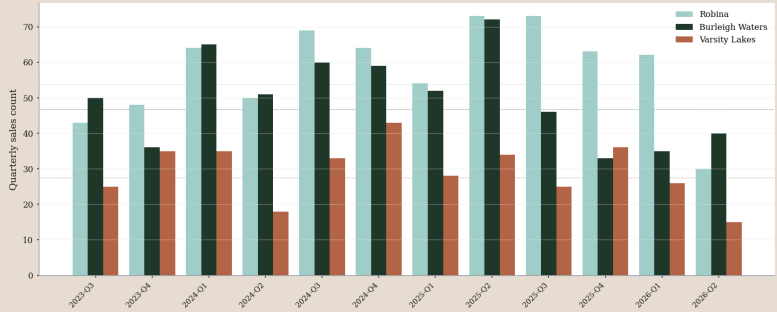
Rolling prices up, single quarters wobbling — the trend is the trailing line.

WHAT ACTIVITY DID — THE REAL STORY

Fewer sales, slower sales

Quarterly sales volume by suburb

Latest complete quarter, 2026 Q2: Robina 30 (-44% vs 5-yr avg); Burleigh Waters 40 (-15% vs 5-yr avg); Varsity Lakes 15 (-45% vs 5-yr avg). The in-progress quarter is excluded.

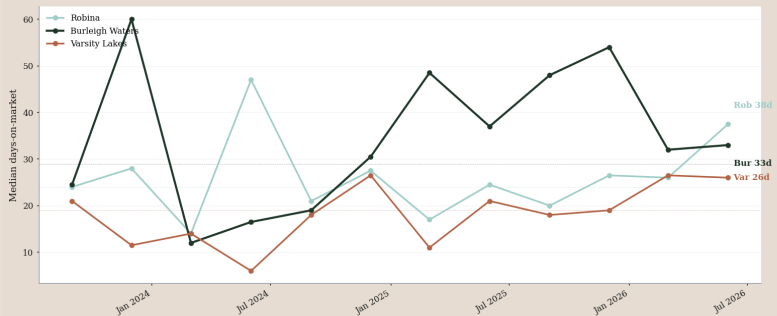


Source: precomputed_market_charts.(suburb)_sales_volume. Houses only, deduplicated. Dashed lines show each suburb's historical quarterly average.

Quarterly house sales, deduplicated. Q2 2026 ran below each suburb's five-year average and well below a year earlier.

Median days-on-market by suburb

Days-on-market has lengthened in Robina and Varsity Lakes; Burleigh Waters is essentially in line with its historical median. Dashed lines show each suburb's historical median.



Source: precomputed_market_charts.(suburb)_days_on_market. List-to-unconditional, private-treaty + auction combined. Sample sizes per quarter in the appendix.

Median days-on-market. Robina and Varsity Lakes have slowed; Burleigh Waters sits near its long-run median.

READING THE DAYS-ON-MARKET CURVE

Time-on-market is the market's patience gauge. A home's clock runs longest in its first weeks; interest is highest early, then eases. When the median stretches — Robina from 24 to 38 days — more homes sit past that early window before a buyer commits. Prices can hold while this happens: buyers taking longer to decide, not sellers dropping their price.

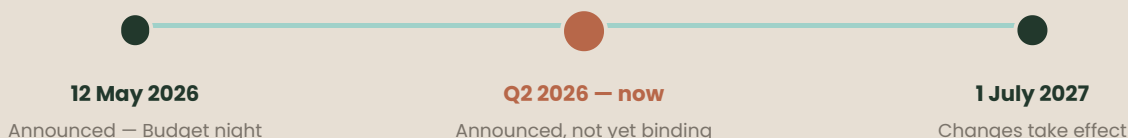
Turnover ran roughly half its year-earlier level in Robina and Varsity Lakes, and down 44% in Burleigh Waters. Fewer homes traded, and the ones that did took longer — yet cleared at firm prices.

When homes take longer to sell but prices hold, someone is being patient. The data doesn't yet say who blinks.

THE RULE CHANGE BENEATH THE NUMBERS

A tax reform enters the calculus

On Budget night, 12 May 2026, the Federal Government announced the biggest change to property tax settings in a generation. It doesn't take effect until 1 July 2027 — but it landed inside this quarter, and it is already part of how buyers and sellers are thinking.



NEGATIVE GEARING

From 1 July 2027, investors who buy **established** homes after 12 May 2026 can no longer offset rental losses against wages. Homes owned before Budget night are grandfathered, and **new builds stay fully negatively gearable**.

CAPITAL GAINS TAX

The 50% CGT discount is replaced by cost-base indexation plus a 30% minimum tax on net gains, for gains accruing from 1 July 2027. Earlier gains keep the old treatment.

The Commonwealth Bank estimates the package leaves established house prices about **3% lower than they otherwise would have been**. The southern Gold Coast's \$700,000–\$1,300,000 mid-market has drawn steady investor interest, so it is the segment most exposed — while first-home buyers are pushed the other way: the 5% deposit guarantee had its caps removed in October 2025, and Help to Buy (QLD cap \$1,000,000) now reaches all three suburbs.

What the data shows — and can't. In the two months after the announcement, volumes fell and listings rose. But three rate rises and the tax news landed in the same window, so the slowdown can't be pinned on one cause — and because the change doesn't bind until 2027, its fuller effect is still ahead. We've shown the overlap rather than pick a story.

WHY MARKETS GO QUIET

When rates rise and the rules change at once, buyers and sellers both wait — not because anyone is being foolish, but because uncertainty has a real cost, and waiting is how a market absorbs it. Thinner volume is what caution looks like in the data — a normal phase of a cycle, not a verdict on value.

We didn't sell these homes. We read them.

Six recent sales across the three suburbs, examined the way our *Before You List* method examines any sale — method, pricing, presentation, time on market — and set against what the data shows. They aren't our listings. They're the quarter, told in transactions.



ROBINA · METHOD OF SALE

138 Camberwell Circuit

5 bed · 3 bath · 4 car · 920 m² · lakefront, 22 m frontage

Sold \$2,410,000 · auction · Apr 2026

Taken to auction rather than listed with a price — the method our research ties to homes outside the ordinary comparable set. A lakefront with few true comparables lets a public deadline find the number; it cleared at more than double the \$960,000 paid in 2020. *Read against the quarter: depth remains at the distinctive top end, even as broad turnover thins.*



ROBINA · PRECISE PRICING

16 Collingwood Avenue

4 bed · 2 bath · 2 car · single-level

Sold \$1,700,000 · guided \$1,749,000 · Jul 2026

Guided close to market and sold inside 3% of the guide. The pricing research holds: a realistic guide clears near ask with a small negotiation, where an ambitious one invites the "why is this priced high?" question and a longer campaign. *Read against the quarter: buyers have a little negotiating room, but a well-priced Robina home still transacts.*

THE EVIDENCE · BURLEIGH WATERS

Cooling by volume, not value



BURLEIGH WATERS · PRECISE PRICING

22 Lanai Drive

4 bed · 2 bath · 2 car · single-level family home

Sold \$1,640,000 · guided \$1,695,000 · Jul 2026

A four-bedroom family home guided realistically and settled inside ~3% — close to ask, with room to negotiate. *Read against the quarter: the homes priced to the market are still clearing, even as fewer of them trade.*



BURLEIGH WATERS · WHAT DRIVES VALUE

15 Anthony Drive

3 bed · single-level · tightly-held pocket

Sold \$1,600,000 · Jul 2026

A three-bedroom that cleared at \$1,600,000 in July. Beneath the suburb's premium headline, it is location and land in a supply-constrained pocket — the attributes our analysis finds actually move price — that hold the mid-market. *Read against the quarter: the value under the headline is still bid.*

On method. Every read here traces to *Before You List* — our data-driven guide to how homes actually sell on the southern Gold Coast: pricing precisely to the market, choosing the method of sale to suit the property, and understanding what genuinely moves value. The sales bear the research out.

THE EVIDENCE · VARSITY LAKES

Price holds, urgency eases



Varsity Lakes · POSITION & PRESENTATION

16 South Bay Drive

3 bed · 2 bath · 2 car · lake outlook

Sold \$1,250,000 · guided over \$1,290,000 · Jul 2026

Priced to a lake-facing position — the visual, emotional draw our research ties to a campaign's early peak — it moved inside ~3% of the guide, without last year's urgency. *Read against the quarter: Varsity Lakes' activity is easing while price stays firm.*



Varsity Lakes · TIME ON MARKET

13 Imperia Crescent

3 bed · single-level · established garden

Sold \$1,285,000 · 42 days on market · Jul 2026

Sold after 42 days — longer than the same home would likely have taken a year ago, when Varsity Lakes medians sat near 21 days. A clean illustration of the quarter's lengthening time-on-market: slower to sell, but still clearing at a firm price. *Patience, not discounting.*

The throughline. Across all six, quality homes settled close to a realistic guide or found their number at auction — modest negotiating room returning to buyers while vendors hold their line. Not capitulation. The same story the Conviction Index tells, read in transactions rather than charts.

WHY THIS REPORT EXISTS

About the author



Will Simpson

FOUNDER, FIELDS ESTATE

Fields Estate started with a story about vulnerability — an agent who underquoted my own home by 17%, and a property recommended to us at \$1,100,000–\$1,200,000 that sold for \$1,400,000.

That experience became the reason Fields exists. I built it to give homeowners something I didn't have: data. Not opinions, not the reassuring-but-vague "the market is strong" that agents offer regardless of conditions — actual, verifiable, local analysis that turns a vulnerable seller into an informed one.

Fields analyses sales, market trends and agent performance across the southern Gold Coast, and maintains comparable-sales valuations in Robina, Varsity Lakes and Burleigh Waters. The information asymmetry between agents and homeowners is the single biggest risk to a fair sale price. Reducing it is what Fields does.

I live on the southern Gold Coast. I walk these streets. I photograph these suburbs. I study these markets because they are my community — and the people selling their homes deserve better than what the industry currently provides.

— if you're thinking about your own home, start with the data.

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The data is the product.

This report presents data and analysis for information only — it is not personal or financial advice, and makes no forecast of future prices. Method: house transactions across Robina, Burleigh Waters and Varsity Lakes; trend claims lean on the trailing-12-month median. The Fields Conviction Index is a composite z-score of price, volume and days-on-market against each suburb's five-year history, rebased Q1 2020 = 100 — full method at fieldsestate.com.au/conviction-index. Prices are exact recorded figures. Data close 30 June 2026; case-study sales settled through 23 July 2026. Sources: Fields Real Estate, Domain, ABS, RBA, ATO, CBA. Photography: Fields local photography, southern Gold Coast.

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Live market data

Scan or visit
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